

Joey battered in S.A. Record attempt

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Keith Jarvis of Adelaide, was forced to land after two hours flying in furious rain squalls when he tried to raise the present South Australian duration record of 7 ½ hours.

After days of planning and waiting for suitable conditions, Keith Jarvis, Kevin Sedgman and Reg Harris too the Joey to Sellicks Hill, about 25 miles south of Adelaide, on Tuesday, June 12th.

Sellicks Hill is about 1000 feet high and faces N-W. A wind of about 30 knots was blowing from the sea when parts of the Joey were carried from the trailer, up the hill to a sheltered spot near the summit.

After rigging the aircraft, Jarvis got into the cockpit and got settled. Kevin Sedgman and Reg Harris then picked up the sailplane at the wing end of the struts and walked it forward towards the edge of the slope.

Within a few yards, the Joey was airborne and Jarvis climbed to about 3000 feet. Through heavy rain-squalls and strong winds Joey flew about just under cloudbase, but took a heavy pounding through having to fly at 60 to 70 m.p.h. If speed was reduced below 60 m.p.h. It was carried up into the cloud.

Finally, realising that his aircraft was being severely battered, Jarvis flew out to the sea for several miles, drifted backwards until he was once more over land and then landed near a house.

He said afterwards that he now plans to fit the Joey with dive brakes.

From the Flight Log Book of Keith Jarvis
June 1956
Type: Joey
Pilot: Self
Duty: Hand launch Sellicks Hill – gale
2.00 hours